KARABO SHAUN MATLOU

Software Developer | Networking & Cybersecurity
Gauteng, South Africa · 067 092 6356 · shaunmatlou123@gmail.com · github.com/shaunmatlou

PROFILE

Third-year BSc Computer Science student at Eduvos who builds and deploys complete, working systems, not just coursework. Product and platform member of Team CyberThreat, which placed 2nd at HackSecure 2026 with Ubufakazi, a live digital forensics tool that turns scam victims' chats and payment slips into tamper-evident case files; presented the team's security model and impact case to the judges. Built and deployed full-stack web applications in PHP/MySQL and Java, backed by a year of hands-on IT support experience and a strong networking and security foundation. 13 module distinctions to date, including 93% in Computer Network Technologies and 93% in Introduction to Programming.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Languages:** Java, C#, C++, PHP, JavaScript, SQL
- **Web & Backend:** REST APIs (JAX-RS, Jersey), WebSockets, AJAX, Bootstrap 5, environment-based configuration, production deployment
- **Databases:** MySQL, relational schema design, SQL query design
- **Networking:** VLANs, DHCP, OSPF, Cisco Packet Tracer, Linux-based operating systems
- **Security:** Threat modelling, OWASP Top 10, POPIA, evidence hashing (SHA-256, HMAC-SHA256), network security, cryptography fundamentals
- **Tools:** Git and GitHub, NetBeans, Maven, Apache Tomcat, GlassFish, cPanel hosting
- **Concepts:** Object-oriented design, design patterns (Singleton, Factory, Observer, Strategy), data structures and algorithms, concurrency

SELECTED PROJECTS

Ubufakazi — Scam Evidence and Victim-Linking Platform *2026*

HackSecure 2026 (CyberM8), 2nd place | Team CyberThreat, Product & Platform | ubufakazi.netlify.app

- Member of a three-person team that built and demoed live a digital forensics tool turning a scam victim's WhatsApp chats and payment slips into a tamper-evident, police-ready case file.
- Designed and presented the security model to the judges: threat modelling across evidence forgery, framing of innocent accounts, AI prompt injection and data theft, mapped to OWASP Top 10 and POPIA.
- Shaped the bank-facing product and business model: free for victims, with banks subscribing to syndicate alerts and a pre-payment beneficiary warning.

Beautified by Lelo — E-Commerce Site for a Real Client *2026*

PHP, MySQL, PayFast, Courier Guy (ShipLogic) | beautifiedbylelo.co.za

- Built a database-driven store for a wig business, covering products, appointments and custom wig requests, from the client's chosen prototype.
- Merged three team members' code into one codebase and added Courier Guy (ShipLogic) delivery quotes at checkout alongside PayFast payments.

TradeHub — C2C E-Commerce Platform *2025*

PHP 8, MySQL, Bootstrap 5.3, JavaScript/AJAX | tradehubs.infinityfreeapp.com · github.com/shaunmatlou/tradehub

- Designed and built a customer-to-customer marketplace with admin role-based access control (RBAC) and a messaging system.
- Deployed to live hosting with environment-based configuration, and fixed cross-environment bugs in navigation paths, deprecation warnings and duplicate markup.

Patel Hardware — Java RESTful Web Service *2025*

Java, Maven, Jersey, Jackson, MySQL, Apache Tomcat 10.1

- Built a full-stack inventory management system with 11 Java servlet classes and 7 HTML front-end pages.
- Designed the MySQL schema, configured Maven dependencies for RESTful delivery, and tested end to end on Apache Tomcat.

HONOURS & AWARDS

- 2nd Place, HackSecure 2026 (CyberM8), Track 4: Digital Forensics. Recognised for Ubufakazi with Team CyberThreat.
- 13 module distinctions across two years of study at Eduvos (2024 and 2025).

EDUCATION

BSc Computer Science — Eduvos *Feb 2024 - Present*

NQF Level 7 | SAQA ID 120721 | 265 credits completed (transcript, July 2026)

- Year 1 (2024), 8 distinctions: Computer Network Technologies (93%), Introduction to Programming using C++ (93%), Generic Algorithm Design (87%), AI Ethics and Privacy (86%), Computer Network and Security (83%), Linux-based Operating Systems (83%), Computer Skills (81%), Non-Technical Skills for IT Professionals (76%).

- Year 2 (2025), 5 distinctions: Object-Oriented Programming in C# (86%), Network Security (83%), Artificial Intelligence Techniques (82%), Database Systems (81%), Data Structures and Algorithms in C# (75%).
- Year 3 (2026, in progress): Object Oriented Systems Analysis and Design (passed), Project, Business Management and Entrepreneurship.
- Further coursework: Advanced Networking, Cloud Based Technologies, Software Design, IT Project Management, Computer Architecture, Digital Electronics and Microcontrollers, Mathematics 1A and 1B.

National Senior Certificate (Bachelor pass) — Curro Thatchfield *2022*

EXPERIENCE & LEADERSHIP

IT Support Intern — 3C Ministries *1 year*

- Provided day-to-day IT support, troubleshooting hardware, software and network issues for staff and facilities.
- Helped maintain and configure networked systems and general technical infrastructure in a live operational environment.

Varsity Basketball — Point Guard / Shooting Guard

- Competed at varsity level alongside full-time studies, building discipline, time management and team leadership.

Cell Group & Church Ministry

- Active member of a weekly cell group and church ministry, reflecting consistency, integrity and service.

References available on request